Ziqi Yang

HCI & AI Researcher

ziqiy30@uci.edu
ziqi-yang.vercel.app
ziqiyang0605
EugeniaYang
mOC0708AAAAJ

Research Profile

Ph.D. researcher in **Human–AI Interaction**, building and evaluating AI agents and **LLM-powered interactive systems** for creative work and healthcare. I combine agentic workflows, full-stack prototyping, and mixed-methods evaluation, with a focus on voice interaction, tool use, and user control.
Industry experience: **Adobe Research**, **Microsoft**, **eBay**, and **Xiaohongshu**.

Education

2024-2029 (Expected) **Ph.D. in Informatics**, *University of California, Irvine*
GPA: **4.00/4.00** Advisor: Yunan Chen, Daniel Epstein

2021-2023 **M.S. in Information**, *University of Michigan, Ann Arbor*
GPA: **3.93/4.00** Focus: Human-Computer Interaction and User Experience
Research Advisor: Mark Newman, Pedja Klasnja

2021-2021 **Visiting Student**, *University of California, Berkeley*

2018-2022 **B.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering**, *Shanghai Jiao Tong University*
Research Advisor: Zhanxun Dong

Selected Publications

CHI 2026 **Sharing Women's Health Experiences Influenced by Genetic Factors: Practices, Challenges, and Opportunities**
Ziqi Yang, Daniel A. Epstein, and Yunan Chen. *[C.4]*
DOI: 10.1145/3772318.3790514

CSCW 2026 **RECOVER: Designing a Large Language Model-based Remote Patient Monitoring System for Postoperative GI Cancer Care**
Ziqi Yang, Yuxuan Lu, Jennifer Bagdasarian, Vedant Das Swain, Ritu Agarwal, Collin Campbell, Waddah Al-Refaire, Jehan El-Bayoumi, Guodong Gao, Nawar Shara, Dakuo Wang, and Bingsheng Yao.
PACMHCI. [C.3] DOI: 10.1145/3788068

IMWUT 2024 **Talk2Care: An LLM-based Voice Assistant for Communication between Healthcare Providers and Older Adults**
Ziqi Yang*, Xuhai Xu*, Bingsheng Yao, Ethan Rogers, Shao Zhang, Stephen Intille, Nawar Shara, Guodong Gordon Gao, and Dakuo Wang. **Equal contribution. [C.2]*
DOI: 10.1145/3659625
★ **Distinguished Paper Award**

Science Robotics 2025 **Observing a robot peer's failures facilitates students' classroom learning**
Liuqing Chen*, Yu Cai*, Yuyang Fang, **Ziqi Yang**, Duowei Xia, Jiaxiang You, Shuhong Xiao, Yaxuan Song, Lingwei Zhan, Juanjuan Chen, and Lingyun Sun. **Equal contribution. [J.1]*
DOI: 10.1126/scirobotics.adu5257

AMIA 2026 **Family Context, Reproductive Experiences, and Digital Engagement in Relation to Women's Genetic Health Knowledge, Perceptions, and Communication**
Ziqi Yang, Weijun Li, Di Hu, Daniel A. Epstein, and Yunan Chen. *Accepted. [C.5]*

Industry Research Experience

Summer 2026 **Adobe Research** | *Research Intern*
Streaming Voice Agents for Creative Image Editing
- Built a **streaming voice-driven AI agent** for creative image editing in React/TypeScript and Node.js/Express, integrating STT/ASR, TTS, LLM intent parsing, and tool orchestration; deployed FLUX-2 (a rectified-flow diffusion transformer) for GPU inference and used Hugging Face for model experimentation.
- Designed **human-in-the-loop agentic workflows** for continuous spoken input and multi-step image editing, enabling users to inspect and revise AI actions, iteratively refine images, and retain creative control.
- Led formative studies ($N = 7$) and a **within-subject user study** ($N = 6$) against a turn-based baseline; collected and analyzed **timestamped behavioral event logs** alongside NASA-TLX, Creativity Support Index, and interviews to assess workload, creativity support, and perceived control.

Academic Research Experience

2026–Present **University of California, Irvine** | *Graduate Student Researcher*

AI-Agent-Assisted Personal Health Software Development (Ongoing)

- Curated **124 web records** documenting health-related personal software (94 personal-website pages and 30 hosted blog posts), preserving full text, source provenance, and screening metadata.
- Conducting **qualitative content analysis** of LLM- and AI-agent-assisted development to characterize health goals, data practices, customization, and verification challenges, with the aim of informing user-configurable personal health agents.

2025–2026 **University of California, Irvine** | *Research Collaborator*

Human-Centered Evaluation of Ambient Clinical AI [J.2, J.3]

- Conducted **data annotation** of clinician edits to AI-generated clinical notes; iteratively refined **annotation guidelines** to characterize edit patterns and clinician rationales and support AI model development.
- Combined inductive and deductive analysis of clinician interviews and annotated edits to identify **failure modes** and inform clinician review, correction, and oversight of AI-assisted documentation, collaborating with clinical and informatics researchers.

2024–2026 **University of California, Irvine** | *Graduate Student Researcher*

Women's Health and Family Communication [C.4, C.5]

- Designed and conducted a **mixed-method survey with 249 U.S. women** on sharing health experiences influenced by genetic factors within families.
- Combined thematic analysis with ordinal logistic regression, Spearman's correlation, and χ^2 analyses to examine how reproductive experiences, family context, and digital engagement shape genetic-health knowledge and communication.
- Conducting a systematic review of 320 ACM papers and translating findings into requirements for AI-supported, women-centered health technologies for family sensemaking and cross-generational communication.

2024 **Zhejiang University** | *Research Assistant*

Generative AI, Social Robots, and Learning [J.1]

- Programmed Python behaviors for a NAO social robot and designed a between-subject experiment on generative-AI-driven embodied learning.
- Evaluated learning and affective outcomes using **ANCOVA and thematic analysis**, identifying 23 axial codes and 6 themes with inter-rater reliability $\kappa = 0.85$.

2023–2024 **Northeastern University** | *Graduate Student Research Assistant*

Conversational AI and Multimodal Systems for Patient–Provider Communication [C.1–C.3]

- Designed and prototyped **LLM-powered voice assistants** and multimodal AI systems for patient–provider communication and monitoring, including Talk2Care, RECOVER, and CardioAI.
- Built voice assistants and clinician dashboards using GPT-4, Alexa, AWS Lambda (Python), and React, integrating conversational and wearable-sensing data.
- Used **annotation-based evaluation** to assess **AI response quality**, accuracy, hallucinations, and **safety risks**; complemented this with interviews, mixed-method user studies, longitudinal deployments, and computational analyses to evaluate system usability. Talk2Care received an IMWUT Distinguished Paper Award.

2022–2024 **University of Michigan, Ann Arbor** | *Graduate Student Research Assistant*

Human-Centered AI for Behavior Change

- Prototyped empathetic exercise-coach chatbots and LLM-powered just-in-time adaptive interventions; conducted pilot studies, surveys, interviews, and crowdsourced analyses to study long-term user–AI interaction.

Other Internship Experience

2023 **Xiaohongshu (RED)** | *Product Manager Intern*

Designed an unbiased sampling hierarchy and review dashboards for live-streaming content; used **A/B testing and SQL** to evaluate search and recommendation models, improving review accuracy by 10% and precision–recall consistency by 5%.

2023 **eBay** | *Product Manager Intern*

Conducted user research and prototyped developer workflows for **Data Lake Studio**, supporting big-data processing and machine-learning pipelines; developed product roadmaps for access-control and data-pipeline features.

2022 **Microsoft** | *User Experience Designer Intern*

Conducted competitive analysis and journey mapping, then designed **AI-supported collaboration** and management features for Dynamics 365 supply-chain workflows in partnership with product managers and engineers.

2019 **Hangzhou InfoCore Technology** | *Software Engineer Intern*

Tested cloud-backup data pipelines in the Hadoop ecosystem (HDFS and MapReduce) using Java, R, and Python, and analyzed Soft-RoCE for multi-tenant data workflows.

Technical & Research Skills

AI Systems	Agentic AI workflows, AI agents, tool orchestration, LLM APIs, prompt engineering, multimodal and generative AI, streaming STT/ASR and TTS, **LLM evaluation**, Hugging Face, FLUX-2, Gemini 3, Amazon Bedrock and SageMaker
Programming	Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, React, Node.js/Express, Flask, AWS Lambda, SQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, R, C/C++
Methods	Mixed-method studies, controlled experiments, contextual inquiry, interviews, thematic analysis, survey design, A/B testing, regression, ANCOVA, interaction-log analysis
Design	Figma, Adobe XD, Illustrator, Miro, Tableau

Additional Publications

C.1 Siyi Wu, Weidan Cao, Shihan Fu, Bingsheng Yao, Ziqi Yang, Changchang Yin, Varun Mishra, Daniel Addison, Ping Zhang, and Dakuo Wang. 2025.
"CardioAI: A Multimodal AI-based System to Support Symptom Monitoring and Risk Prediction of Cancer Treatment-Induced Cardiotoxicity."
CHI '25, DOI: 10.1145/3706598.3714272

J.3 Yawen Guo, Di Hu, Ziqi Yang, Seungjun Kim, Brian Tran, Jamie Lee, Sitha Vallabhaneni, Rachael Zehrung, Sairam Sutari, Steven Tam, Emilie Chow, Danielle Perret, Deepti Pandita, and Kai Zheng.
"What do clinicians edit in ambient AI-drafted clinical documentation? A qualitative content analysis."
JAMIA, 2026, DOI: 10.1093/jamia/ocag073

J.2 Yawen Guo, Di Hu, Ziqi Yang, Emilie Chow, Steven Tam, Danielle Perret, Deepti Pandita, and Kai Zheng. "Clinicians' rationale for editing ambient AI-drafted clinical notes: persistent challenges and implications for improvement."
JAMIA, 2026, DOI: 10.1093/jamia/ocag059

Honors & Awards

2026 **Bob & Barbara Kleist Endowed Graduate Fellowship ($3000)**, *School of Informatics and Computer Science, UC Irvine*

2025 **Bob & Barbara Kleist Endowed Graduate Fellowship ($3000)**, *School of Informatics and Computer Science, UC Irvine*

2024 **Chair's Award ($2500)**, *School of Informatics and Computer Science, UC Irvine*

2021 **Student Development Scholarship (¥1500)**, *UM-SJTU Joint Institute*